

CURRICULUM VITAE

Aytakin Huseynli, PhD, MSW

Assistant Research Professor

Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, St. Louis, Missouri, United States

Contact and identifiers

Full name (as in publications)	Aytakin Huseynli
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Scientific field	Social policy; social work

Profile summary

Aytakin Huseynli is an assistant research professor at the Brown School of Washington University in St. Louis, where she has worked since 2024. She was a postdoctoral scholar there in 2022–2024. She received a PhD from the Brown School in 2022. The dissertation is Exploring the Relationship between Resource Curse and Child Wellbeing, specifically in post-Soviet Countries, chaired by Michael Sherraden. She received an MSW from the Brown School in 2005 and a bachelor's degree in English and German philology from Azerbaijan State University of Languages in 1995. She is also a regional household-survey consultant for UNICEF Europe and Central Asia.

Education

Years	Degree	Field / thesis title	Institution, city, country
2022–2024	Postdoctoral scholar		Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, United States
2022	PhD	Dissertation: Exploring the Relationship between Resource Curse and Child Wellbeing, specifically in post-Soviet Countries. Chair: Michael Sherraden	Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, United States
2005	MSW		Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, United States
1995	Bachelor's degree	English and German philology	Azerbaijan State University of Languages, Azerbaijan

Academic and professional positions

Years	Position	Department / unit	Institution, city, country
2024–present	Assistant Research Professor		Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, United States
2022–present	Regional household-survey consultant		UNICEF Europe and Central Asia
2019–2022	Data, statistics, research, and evaluation expert for Eurasia		UNICEF

Years	Position	Department / unit	Institution, city, country
2015–2022	Graduate research associate		Center for Social Development, Washington University in St. Louis
2018–2022	Graduate research assistant		Center for Innovation in Child Maltreatment Policy, Research, and Training, Washington University in St. Louis
2018–2019	Graduate research assistant		Social Policy Institute, Washington University in St. Louis
2015–2017	Graduate research assistant		Crown Family School of Social Work, Practice and Policy, University of Chicago
2009–2014	Head of the country office in Azerbaijan		Hilfsverk Austria International
2009–present	Founder and board member		Azerbaijan Public Social Work Union
2007–2010	National consultant on social work		UNICEF
2007–2013	National scholar for higher-education reform support		Open Society Foundations
2007 and 2009	National consultant on child protection		UNICEF
2006–2007	Senior advisor to the minister	Direct practice with children and families	Ministry of Labor and Social Protection of Azerbaijan
2004–2006	Family support manager	Direct practice with children and families	Save the Children

Publications

Book chapters

1. **Huseynli, A.** (2018). Predictors of child marriages in Azerbaijan: Multilevel analysis. In L. Sayfutdinova, C. Buckley, & A. Valiyev (Eds.), *Study Series on Public Policy Issues* (Vol. 1, pp. 178–197). Caucasus Resource Center.
2. **Huseynli, A.** (2023). The role of social workers in achieving sustainable development goals in Azerbaijan. In D. Androff & J. Damanik (Eds.), *International handbook on social work, social development, and the sustainable development goals*. Routledge.

Peer-reviewed journal articles

1. **Huseynli, A.** (2022). Asset building policies to lift the resource curse: child development accounts in oil-and-gas-rich countries. *Children and Youth Services Review*, 145, 106717.
2. **Huseynli, A.** (2022). Social work education in post-soviet countries: progress of Azerbaijan. *The British Journal of Social Work*, 53(5), 2560–2580.
3. **Huseynli, A., & Jonson-Reid, M.** (2022). Child well-being in post-Soviet countries: discipline practices in families in Azerbaijan. *Child Indicators Research*, 16(1), 317–336.
4. **Huseynli, A.** (2022). Social work in Azerbaijan: achievements and challenges of the profession. *International Social Work*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/00208728221075824>.
5. Kennedy, A., Kaushik, G., Dubinsky, E., Jonson-Reid, M., & **Huseynli, A.** (2021). Direct and indirect cost savings from STI testing, treatment, and counseling among foster youth. *Sexually Transmitted Disease*, 49(1), 86–89. <https://doi.org/10.1097/OLQ.0000000000001511>.

6. Rosen, M. H., Pinto, O., Kondratjeva, O., Roll, S. P., **Huseynli, A.**, & Grinstein-Weiss, M. (2020). Household savings decisions in Israel's child savings program: The role of demographic, financial, and intrinsic factors. *Journal of Family & Economic Issues*, 42, 368–386. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10834-020-09724-6>.
7. **Huseynli, A.** (2018). Implementation of deinstitutionalization of childcare institutions in postsoviet countries: The case of Azerbaijan. *Child Abuse and Neglect*, 76, 160–172. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chiabu.2017.10.020>.
8. Ismayilova, L., Ssewamala, F., & **Huseynli, A.** (2014). Reforming child institutional care in the Post-Soviet bloc: The potential role of family-based empowerment strategies. *Children and Youth Services Review*, 47(2), 136–148. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.childyouth.2014.09.007>.

Grants and research projects

Years	Project title	Funding body	Your role
2020–2021	Labor rights of people with disabilities in Azerbaijan, Georgia, and Moldova. Principal investigator. \$31,000	European Union, Eastern Partnership Civil Society Forum	
2018	Awareness raising on child savings accounts and Child Development Accounts in Azerbaijan. Principal investigator. \$7,000	Azerbaijan government funding for nonprofits	
2017–2018	Upgrading national social work education quality standards to comply with global standards. Principal investigator. \$7,000	International Association of Schools of Social Work	
2017	Applying an ecological perspective to increase mental-health awareness among children. Principal investigator. \$6,500	BEARR Trust Small Grants Scheme, United Kingdom	
2015–2017	Shaping sustainable social change by strengthening social workers and their associations in Moldova, Georgia, Azerbaijan, and Armenia. Co-principal investigator. \$500,000	European Union and Austrian Development Agency	
2014	Examining the relationship between the resource curse and child well-being in Azerbaijan. Principal investigator. \$6,000	Open Society Foundations	
2018	Finding local needs and conditions for Child Development Accounts. Principal investigator. \$7,000	Center for Social Development, Washington University in St. Louis	
2019–2020	Dissertation grant. \$22,000	Washington University in St. Louis	

Awards, honors and fellowships

Year	Award / honor	Awarding body
2024	Outstanding Social Work Doctoral Dissertation Award, honorable mention	Society for Social Work and Research
2018	Award for social work and social development	Ministry of Women, Family and Children Affairs of Azerbaijan
2014	Mary's College Women's Fellowship	Durham University, United Kingdom
2013	Award for the development of social work	Turkish Association of Social Workers
2007	Award for the development of social work	U.S. Embassy in Azerbaijan

Year	Award / honor	Awarding body
2007	Academic Fellowship and Higher Education Support Program	Open Society Foundations
2004	Social Work Fellowship	Open Society Foundations
1999	Women Human Rights Fellowship	Open Society Foundations

Teaching

Years	Course	Level	Institution
	Evaluation of Programs and Services; International Social and Economic Development Policy. Redesigned and taught		Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis
	Practice and Program Evaluation		University of Missouri–St. Louis, School of Social Work
	Research Methods for MBA; Quantitative and Qualitative Data Analysis		Azerbaijan Diplomatic Academy, School of Business
	Social Work with Families and Children; Introduction to Social Work; Family and Child Well-being Policies and Services		Baku State University
	Practice in Global Issues		Saint Louis University, School of Social Work
	Co-taught: Global Anti-poverty Strategies; Evaluation of Programs and Services; Research Methods for Social Sciences with Statistical Application		Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis

Invited talks and conference participation

Year	Event, place	Type	Title of talk
2024	Society for Social Work and Research 28th Annual Conference, Washington, D.C.	Symposium organized	Building Assets for Child Development: A Global Policy Innovation Symposium
2024	Society for Social Work and Research 28th Annual Conference, Washington, D.C.	Paper	Effects of Child Development Accounts on Family Financial Well-Being: Evidence from a Randomized Policy Experiment
2024	Society for Social Work and Research 28th Annual Conference, Washington, D.C.	Paper	Design and Development of Child Development Accounts in Kazakhstan
2024	Society for Social Work and Research 28th Annual Conference, Washington, D.C.	Paper	Governance and child well-being: evidence from low- to middle-income countries
2023	Society for Social Work and Research 27th Annual Conference, Washington, D.C.	Symposium organized	Financial Capability and Asset Building in International Perspective
2023	China Financial Social Work Forum, China	Invited lecture	Asset-building policies in oil-, gas-, and mineral-rich countries: the cases of Kazakhstan and Azerbaijan

Year	Event, place	Type	Title of talk
2023	International Conference on Prevention of Domestic Violence, Baku, Azerbaijan	Invited lecture	Financial capability and asset-building to reduce and prevent domestic violence
2023	Early Childhood Education Conference, Baku, Azerbaijan	Invited lecture	Child maltreatment in early childhood development and education
2023	Early Childhood Education Conference, Baku, Azerbaijan	Invited lecture	U.S. models in community, family, and school collaboration in early childhood education
2023	International Conference on Social Work and Social Research, Baku, Azerbaijan	Invited lecture	Child Development Accounts in oil- and gas-rich countries: the cases of Azerbaijan and Kazakhstan
2023	Baku Business University, Baku, Azerbaijan	Invited lecture	Social work development in Azerbaijan: achievements and challenges
2023	Azerbaijan Social Work Public Union conference, virtual	Invited lecture	What does inclusion, equity, and diversity mean to you?
2023	Society for Social Work and Research 27th Annual Conference, Phoenix, Arizona	Paper	Child well-being in Ukraine, Moldova, Azerbaijan, Georgia, Kazakhstan, and Kyrgyzstan
2018	World Conference on Social Work, Education and Social Development, Dublin, Ireland	Symposium organized	Professionalization of social work in post-socialist countries
2021	Oxford School of Global and Area Studies, University of Oxford, United Kingdom	Invited lecture	Child well-being and child savings accounts in Azerbaijan: theory and possible policy design

Languages

Language	Level
Azerbaijani	Native
English	Fluent
Russian	Fluent
Turkish	Fluent
German	Basic